

Teacher crisis

Himachal Pradesh's schools are **grappling with** a **dire** teacher shortage, with 125 schools **devoid of** educators and 2,600 running with only one teacher. Despite the government's claims of progress, the **challenges** in ensuring quality education **remain stark**. The state government's recent **decision** to **denotify** or **merge** over 1,100 schools with zero or low **enrolment** **has stirred** a controversy. While this measure is **pragmatic**, reallocating teachers from **defunct** schools to understaffed ones, it **highlights** a deeper systemic issue: the **chronic** underfunding and lack of strategic planning in education.

Moreover, the shortage of 12,000 schoolteachers **underscores** the gap between policy intent and implementation. Although recruitment efforts have been initiated, the **reliance on** temporary measures like **deputations** and guest teachers **raises** questions about **sustainability**. The **merging** of institutions and **clustering** of schools for resource sharing **are commendable** steps, but they **address** symptoms rather than root causes. The declining enrolment in government schools adds another **dimension** to the crisis. The **allure** of private institutions, **fuelled** by better facilities and English-medium instruction, **continues** to **draw** students away. While the government's **initiatives** like identifying 'Schools of Excellence' and enhanced teacher training **are** steps in the right direction, they need **robust execution** and **consistent follow-through**.



However, education reform requires more than **infrastructural** improvements. The focus must shift to filling vacancies, addressing regional **disparities** and enhancing the learning experience for students. **Policymakers** should view the education sector not as a political battleground but as a **cornerstone** for the state's future. The government's actions so far indicate intent, but outcomes will depend on **translating** these efforts into **tangible**, long-term benefits. Himachal Pradesh must prioritise the **holistic** revival of its education sector to ensure every child's right to quality learning. **[Practice Exer.]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

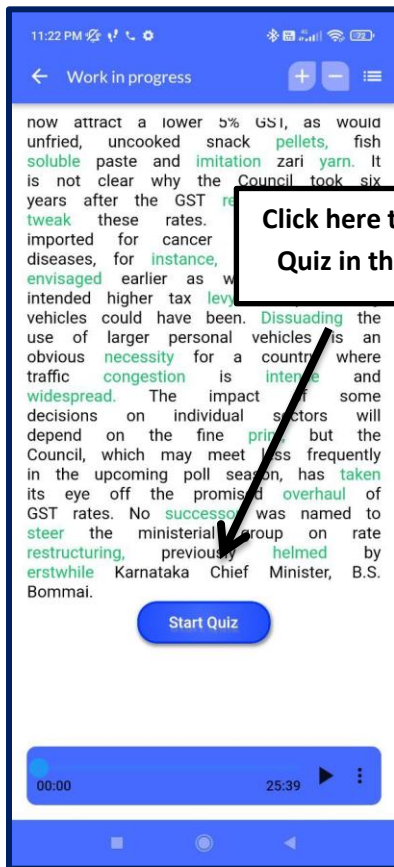
1. **Grapple with** (phrasal verb) – Struggle to deal with, wrestle with, address से जूझना
2. **Dire** (adjective) – Urgent, severe, critical, desperate गम्भीर
3. **Devoid** (of) (adjective) – Lacking, empty of, bereft of, without रहित
4. **Stark** (adjective) – Clear, evident, harsh, striking स्पष्ट
5. **Denotify** (verb) – Cancel the notification, declassify, revoke अधिसूचना रद्द करना
6. **Merge** (verb) – Combine, unify, consolidate, amalgamate मिलाना
7. **Enrolment** (noun) – Registration, admission, signing up, enlistment नामांकन
8. **Stir** (verb) – Provoke, create, instigate, cause उत्पन्न करना
9. **Pragmatic** (adjective) – Practical, realistic, sensible, logical व्यावहारिक
10. **Defunct** (adjective) – No longer in use, obsolete, inactive, abandoned निष्क्रिय
11. **Highlight** (verb) – Emphasize, underscore, point out, bring attention to उजागर करना
12. **Chronic** (adjective) – Persistent, long-term, enduring, constant दीर्घकालिक
13. **Moreover** (adverb) – Additionally, furthermore, also, in addition इसके अलावा
14. **Underscore** (verb) – Emphasize, stress, highlight, underline ज़ोर देना
15. **Reliance** (on) (noun) – Dependence, trust, reliance upon, need for निर्भरता
16. **Deputation** (noun) – Temporary assignment, delegation, secondment अस्थायी नियुक्ति
17. **Sustainability** (noun) – Ability to maintain, long-term viability, endurance, stability टिकाऊपन
18. **Merging** (noun) – Combining, uniting, blending, consolidation विलय
19. **Clustering** (noun) – Grouping together, aggregating, bunching, assembling समूह बनाना
20. **Commendable** (adjective) – Praiseworthy, admirable, deserving recognition प्रशंसनीय
21. **Address** (verb) – Deal with, tackle, focus on, resolve समाधान करना
22. **Dimension** (noun) – Aspect, element, feature, factor आयाम
23. **Allure** (noun) – Attraction, charm, appeal, magnetism आकर्षण
24. **Fuel** (verb) – Encourage, stimulate, ignite, boost बढ़ावा देना

25. **Draw** (verb) – Attract, pull, entice, lure
आकर्षित करना
26. **Robust** (adjective) – Strong, sturdy, solid,
durable मजबूत
27. **Execution** (noun) – Implementation,
performance, carrying out, enforcement
क्रियान्वयन
28. **Consistent** (adjective) – Steady, reliable,
uniform, regular निरंतर
29. **Follow-through** (noun) – Continuation,
commitment to completion, perseverance
कार्यान्वयन
30. **Infrastructural** (adjective) – Relating to the
basic physical systems, structural,
foundational बुनियादी ढाँचा
31. **Disparity** (noun) – Inequality, difference,
gap, imbalance असमानता
32. **Policymaker** (noun) – Decision-maker,
lawmaker, administrator नीति निर्माता
33. **Cornerstone** (noun) – Foundation, basis,
essential element, keystone नींव/मूल
आधार
34. **Translate** (verb) – Convert, transform,
interpret, carry over परिवर्तित करना
35. **Tangible** (adjective) – Concrete, real,
measurable, definite ठोस
36. **Holistic** (adjective) – Comprehensive, all-
encompassing, integrated समग्र

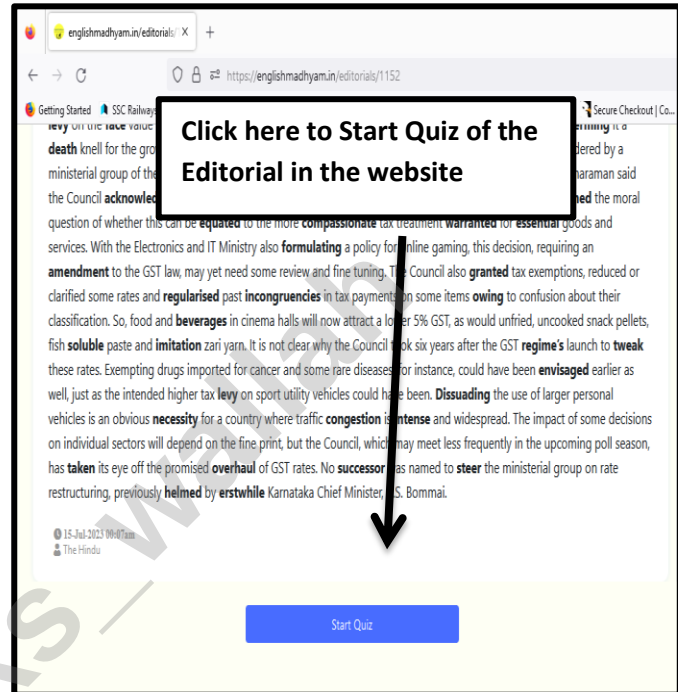
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Teacher Shortage:** Himachal Pradesh's schools face a severe teacher crisis, with 125 schools having no teachers and 2,600 schools with only one teacher.
2. **Denotification of Schools:** The state government decided to denotify or merge over 1,100 schools with zero or low enrolment, sparking controversy.
3. **Pragmatic Measure:** The decision aims to reallocate teachers from defunct schools to understaffed ones, addressing the immediate shortage.
4. **Systemic Issue:** The crisis highlights chronic underfunding and the absence of strategic planning in the education sector.
5. **12,000 Teacher Vacancies:** The shortage underscores a gap between policy intentions and actual implementation.
6. **Temporary Solutions:** Reliance on deputations and guest teachers raises concerns about sustainability.
7. **Resource Sharing:** Initiatives like clustering schools for resource sharing address symptoms but fail to tackle the root causes.
8. **Declining Enrolment:** Reduced enrolment in government schools reflects a loss of trust in the public education system.
9. **Private School Attraction:** Better facilities and English-medium instruction in private schools are drawing students away.
10. **Schools of Excellence:** Government initiatives like identifying 'Schools of Excellence' and enhancing teacher training show promise but require effective execution.
11. **Infrastructural vs. Systemic Reform:** Infrastructure improvements alone are insufficient; systemic reforms are essential for long-term benefits.
12. **Vacancy Filling:** Filling teacher vacancies must be prioritized to ensure quality education delivery.
13. **Addressing Disparities:** Regional disparities in education need urgent attention to ensure equitable learning opportunities.
14. **Education as a Priority:** Policymakers should treat education as a foundation for the state's future, rather than a political tool.
15. **Holistic Revival Needed:** Himachal Pradesh must focus on a holistic revival of its education sector to secure every child's right to quality learning.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



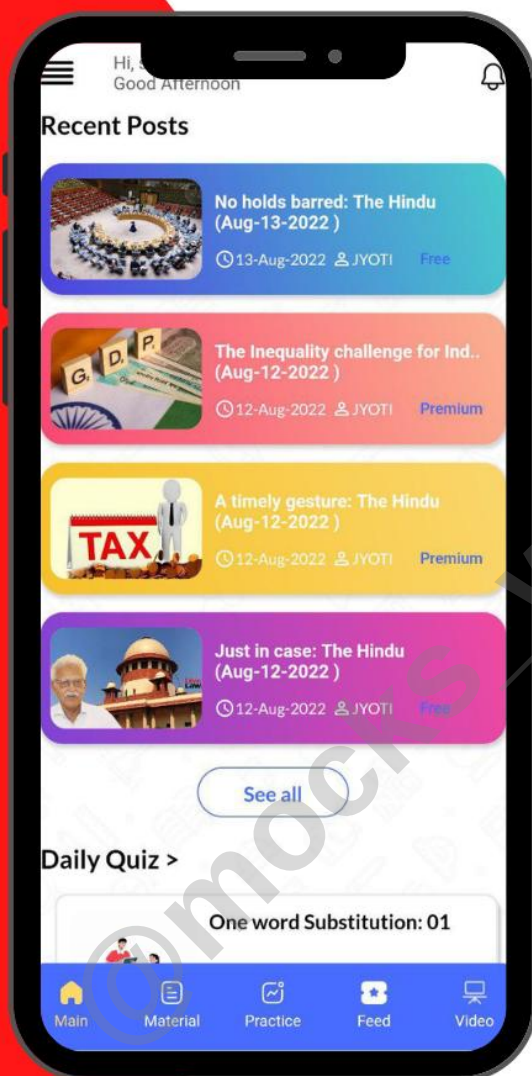
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